Empirical Theory

The universe is fundamentally knowable.

Through observation and falsifiable predictions, even the most mysterious phenomena can be understood. Your powers are best described as manipulating your Yau-body entanglement to induce a cascade of free energy as predicted by Orthodynamic Field Theory.

If you choose this outlook, the Intelligence specialty styles *Episemiotics* and *Polymath* are replaced by the alternative styles *Embed Function* and *Embed Cast*.

Tier 2: Embed Function

This style allows you to create items with artifact functions. In order to acquire this style you must have had the chance to thoroughly examine at least one item with artifact functions.

Creating an artifact is an extended action with an interval of a week and a roll of **Intelligence + Hardware**. When creating an item, each function rank you wish to add requires 6 successes to be accumulated. Each function rank you wish to add to an item requires about $1000 worth or raw materials.

Adding functions to existing artifacts can be done at the same rate of 6 successes and $1000 per rank. Removing functions can be done for just 1 success per rank. However, if you are not the original creator of the artifact, the first time you try to change its functions you must roll 3 successes to familiarize yourself with the item before changing it.

You cannot add more than a single primary function to an item or create artifacts with the Cast form factor or without the style *Embed Cast*.

Rank 1: You can create items with a primary function of any rank.

Rank 2: You can create items with a single parameter of any rank.

Rank 3: You can create items with all three parameters that their primary function can host.

Tier 3: Embed Cast

This style allows you to create artifacts that can interface with the human body smoothly enough to have the Cast form factor. It also increases the number of primary functions you can add to any artifact. If you do not also have ranks in *Embed Function*, you can only make items with the first rank of their primary function. If you do have ranks in *Embed Function*, any primary function can have ranks and parameters according to your rank in that style.

This style also allows you to safely remove casts from yourself or other cast hosts that are either willing or unconscious. Removing a cast takes few hours to accomplish.

Rank 1: You can create casts with a single primary function.

Rank 2: You can create casts or other artifacts with up to two primary functions.

Rank 3: You can create casts or other artifacts with up to three primary functions.

Crisis Paradigm

The natural world arises from balance.

Balance between extremes defines the emergent phenomena behind all of nature and humanity. Your Entanglement is best understood as temporary imbalance in nature, by carefully releasing the tension of this small crisis of balance your styles become manifest.

If you choose this outlook, the Willpower specialty styles *Persistence* and *Extropy* are replaced by the alternative styles *Reverberation* and *Familiar*.

Tier 2: Reverberation

A meditation practice taught by those that view Entanglement as a temporary imbalance in nature, Reverberation allows you to store a large pool of temporary Entanglement points.

To use this style you must maintain concentration. Taking any damage, making any rolls that involve the skill Guts or any combat skill, or otherwise being severely distracted breaks this concentration. Once this concentration ends, any unused temporary Entanglement gained while concentrating fades away after a number of minutes equal to your Charisma score.

While concentrating, and for the first minute afterwards, you are immune to any discomfort and to any penalties or damage from crisis sickness that high levels of Entanglement may cause. After this minute, if your Entanglement is still boosted it effects you normally.

Rank 1: For each minute spent concentrating on this style, gain one temporary point of Entanglement. The maximum amount of temporary Entanglement you can store this way is three. You cannot spend any Entanglement while concentrating.

Rank 2: For each minute spent concentrating on this style, gain two temporary points of Entanglement. The maximum amount of temporary Entanglement you can store this way is equal to your normal Entanglement maximum. You can now spend Entanglement while concentrating, but it comes from your original Entanglement total, not the temporary points.

Rank 3: For each minute spent concentrating on this style, gain three temporary points of Entanglement. The maximum amount of temporary Entanglement you can store this way is equal to either your normal Entanglement maximum or your current Entanglement total, whichever is higher. If you spend Entanglement while concentrating you may choose if it comes from your original current total or from the temporary pool.

Tier 3: Familiar

Detached fragments of Yau-bodies roam the Yau. These liminally conscious entities, sometimes referred to as Yau spirits, are barely detectable most of the time. With this style you become able to reliably detect and interact with these entities.

Yau spirits vary widely from sub-animal to super-human levels of awareness or Intelligence and from undetectable to unavoidable. They may be completely ignorant of, or extremely aware of, events in the physical world. They also may have differing methods of communication, anything from direct telepathy, spoken word, manifested writing, or editing digital content are possible.

Rank 1: Regardless of the nature of any entity in the Yau you can always detect it and find a way to communicate with it.

Rank 2: You can induce the ***Coalesce Familiar*** non-combat cascade event.

Coalesce Familiar
By merging fragments of your own psyche and other minor Yau spirits you create a new entity in the Yau known as a familiar. This familiar is loyal to you and exists for as long as you have at least one point of Entanglement. It can travel through the Yau independently of you at high speeds and communicate back to you telepathically at any distance. Familiars can observe any event in the Yau or in physical space, but otherwise cannot influence, or be detected from, physical space.

Rank 3: Familiars you create can manifest enough influence on physical space to slowly move any unattended object that weighs less than 3 kilograms. You can also direct them to make a proxy out of any non-human animal you encounter that has a weak Yau-body. This includes all fish, reptiles, birds, as well as newborn mammals. Your familiar has complete control of this animal for as long as you have at least three points of Entanglement.

Consensus Praxis

Belief shapes all of reality.

The world is little more than the ontological consensus of the beliefs of its inhabitants. Your powers arise from the knowledge that this consensus is mutable and that your will can briefly overcome it as long as you truly believe it can.

If you choose this outlook, the Charisma specialty styles *Healing* and *Combat Healing* are replaced by the alternative styles *Influence* and *Illusion*.

Tier 2: Influence

One of the earliest purposes the Yau-body evolved to fill was a primitive way to identify friends and foes within one's own species. This style allows you to hijack the vestiges of this system in humans in order to gain their trust.

Rank 1: You can induce the Charm Person non-combat cascade event.

Charm Person
A single person you can see must succeed on a **Willpower + Guts** roll with a difficulty equal to your Charisma score or their opinion of you will be changed to that of a stranger or an acquaintance for the rest of the scene. If you choose stranger, they will not recognize you no matter how familiar they were previously. If you choose acquaintance, they will regard you as someone they have met before and have generally positive feelings towards. If you spend more than a minute interacting with a charmed target they will know you manipulated them in some way.

Rank 2: You can now use the a successful ***Charm Person*** event to cause the target to regard you as a trusted friend. They will still use their common sense when it comes to detecting deceit or deciding to follow through on a request, but they will give you the benefit of the doubt and default to trusting you until you give them a reason not to. If you spend more than three minutes interacting with a charmed target they will know you manipulated them in some way.

Rank 3: You can now use ***Charm Person*** events in combat. Successfully doing so causes the target to become an ally that will not attack you, and with enough convincing may even turn on their previous allies. This effect ends a minute after combat ceases, after which the target becomes aware that they were manipulated.

Using ***Charm Person*** events to create friends, strangers, or acquaintances outside of combat will no longer result in the target knowing they were manipulated after any amount of time.

Tier 3: Illusion

This style is the most effective way to manipulate the consensus on what the nature of reality is without completely violating the laws of physics.

Illusions created by this style are entirely in the mind of those viewing them, they have no manifestation in physical space.

Rank 1: You can induce the ***Create Illusion*** cascade event.

Create Illusion
A single person now begins perceiving an illusion at a point you choose. With one rank in this style, this illusion must be an unmoving two-dimensional visual image no greater than one meter in size. This illusion is flawlessly convincing, although if it suddenly appears in someone's line of sight they will likely be suspicious of it. However, the two-dimensional nature of this image means that as soon as anyone witnessing it moves at least one space they will immediately see the true illusory nature of it. Illusions you create last for a number of minutes equal to your Charisma score.

Rank 2: Your ***Create Illusion*** events can now be up to three meters in size and are visible to a number of people equal to or less than your Charisma score. They are now three-dimensional images that are convincing even after changing viewing angles, however they still do not stand up to any physical inspection. They can include basic animation that lasts no longer than a few seconds before repeating or stopping. They can also include a single non-verbal sound that lasts no longer than a few seconds before repeating or stopping. They can now last for the duration of the scene.

Additionally, you can now induce the ***Suppress Sensorium*** cascade event.

Suppress Sensorium
At any point you can see, create a 9 meter sphere that blocks all vision, including yours. Anyone looking at it from the outside sees only an opaque sphere, anyone inside is blinded

Rank 3: Your ***Create Illusion*** events can now be up to nine meters in size and are perceivable to anyone with line of sight to them. They can fool all senses, including touch and proprioception, well enough that they remain convincing even after a physical inspection and can block movement. They can include any complex animation or audio and last any amount of time up to an hour after you leave the area.

Additionally, your ***Suppress Sensorium*** events can now block all senses. Nothing inside the sphere can be detected and everyone completely loses all of their senses while inside it. However, you are now immune to this event and all of your senses are unaffected by it.